

Jennifer L. Wall, PhD

📍 Cornwall, NY

✉ jwall@blackrockforest.org

🌐 wall-jennifer.github.io/jlwall

Summary

I am a wildlife biologist broadly interested in population and community ecology, theoretical and applied modeling, and behavioral ecology. I have over 10 years of research experience on a variety of taxa and systems, with a current focus on mammalian movement ecology.

Current Appointment

Postdoctoral research fellow

April 2025 - Current

Black Rock Forest, Cornwall, NY &

Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory, Columbia University, NY

Advisors: Dr. Scott LaPoint (BRF) & Dr. Kevin Griffin (Columbia)

I am (1) collaborating on the Hudson Highlands Wildlife Connectivity project to assess wildlife space use and functional landscape connectivity at multiple scales and (2) working to transition and future proof Black Rock Forest's deer population monitoring program. These projects involve field work, data management, and modeling, in addition to assisting with hiring field technicians, submitting grant applications, and disseminating our research to the public.

Skills

Programming languages: R (Intermediate), CSS (Beginner)

Software: ArcGIS and QGIS (Intermediate), Microsoft office and Google suites

Web and Graphic Design: Adobe (Illustrator, Lightroom)

Practical: bird banding (waterbirds, raptors); mist netting (raptors); camera trapping and other non-invasive survey techniques; mesocarnivore trapping (bobcats); snow tracking

Education

Ph.D. Wildlife Biology

2019 - 2024

University of Montana

Missoula, MT, USA

Awarded: *W. A. Franke Graduate Research Fellowship (\$15K)*, *Bertha Morton Scholarship (\$3K)*

Advisor: Dr. Jedediah Brodie

Wall, J.L. "A closer look at Denali's alpine wildlife: Assessing the influences of climate and vegetation changes on species in Alaska" (2024). *Graduate Student Theses, Dissertations, & Professional Papers*: University of Montana. 12293.

B.S. Biological Sciences & B.S. Environmental Science & Policy

2013 - 2017

University of Maryland

College Park, MD, USA

Awarded: *Banneker / Key Scholar (full tuition scholarship)*, *Donald and Katherine Buxton Award for Research Excellence (\$2K)*, *Gemstone Honors student*, *Dean's List*

Mentor: Dr. Joseph H. Sullivan

S. Chelst, B. Delaine-Facey, S.J. Hull, D. Jordan, V. Montsaint-Queeney, M.D. Patel, A. Thapa, **J.**

Wall, and D.A. Yee (alphabetical). "Evaluating the efficacy of cattail (*Typha spp.*) fiber for oil sorption." (2017). *Student Theses*: University of Maryland. <https://doi.org/10.13016/M26T0GW45>

Semester Abroad

2015

James Cook University

Townsville, Queensland, AU

GPA: 6.5 (equivalent to 4.0)

Coursework: Population and Community Ecology (24 hrs field work), Wetland and Estuarine Ecosystems (17 hrs field work), Marine Invertebrates, Rainforest Ecosystems

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Publications in Prep

9. **Wall, J.L.** and J.F. Brodie. 2026. Can marmots & pikas take the heat? Scale-dependent variation in the vulnerability of alpine wildlife to climate changes. *Under review. Ecology.*
8. **Wall, J.L.** and J.F. Brodie. 2026. Patch quality affords behavioral flexibility in collared pikas (*Ochotona collaris*), potentially increasing climate resiliency. *Under review. Oikos.*

Publications (Published to date: 7 peer-reviewed publications, 1 book chapter)

7. Prosser, D.J., J.D. Sullivan, **J.L. Wall**, E.J. Buck, J.J. Taylor, C.R. Callahan, and P.C. McGowan. 2022. Poplar Island: Understanding the Development of a Beneficial Use Restoration Site. *Ecological Restoration*. 40:17-24. doi:10.3368/er.40.1.176.
6. **Wall, J.L.** B. Loken, and J.F. Brodie. 2021. Reconciling resource extraction and species conservation in a multi-use landscape: Immediate and long-term impacts of logging on rainforest mammal diversity. *Global Ecology and Conservation*. 28. doi:10.1016/j.gecco.2021.e01642
5. **Wall, J.**, D. Brinker, S. Weindensaul, D. Okines, P. Côté, and J.F. Therrien. 2021. Twenty-five year population trends in Northern Saw-Whet Owl (*Aegolius acadicus*) in eastern North America. *The Wilson Journal of Ornithology*.
4. Riggs, G.J., J.D. Sullivan, K.M. Harvey, D.A. Pappas, **J.L. Wall**, P.C. McGowan, C.R. Callahan, C.A. Koppie, D.J. Prosser. 2019. Eviction Notice: Observation of a Common Tern (*Sterna hirundo*) Usurping an Active Least Tern (*Sterna antillarum*) Nest. *Northeastern Naturalist*: 26(3): 609-615.
3. McGowan, P.C., J.D. Sullivan, C.C. Callahan, W. Schultz, **J.L. Wall**, and D. Prosser. 2019. Promoting Change in Common Tern (*Sterna hirundo*) Nest Site Selection to Minimize Construction Related Disturbance. *Ecological Restoration*. 37(3):143- 147.
2. **Wall, J.L.**, P.M. Marban, D.F. Brinker, J.D. Sullivan, M. Zimnick, J.L. Murrow, P.C. McGowan, C.R. Callahan, D.J. Prosser. 2018. A Video Surveillance System to Monitor Breeding Colonies of Common Terns (*Sterna Hirundo*). *J. Vis Exp.* (137), e57928.
1. McGowan, P.C., K.M. Reintsma, J.D. Sullivan, K.P. Devoss, **J.L. Wall**, M.D. Zimnik, C.R. Callahan, B. Schultz, D.J. Prosser. 2018. Use of bank swallow (*Riparia riparia*) burrows as microclimates by common terns (*Sterna hirundo*) in high temperature environments. *Waterbirds*: 41(2), 179-182. doi:10.1675/063.041.0210

Book Chapters

1. L.B. Slobodkin and **Wall, J.L.** 2024. Limits to Biodiversity. In: Scheiner S,M, (eds.) *Encyclopedia of Biodiversity 3rd edition*, vol 5, pp. 152-160. Oxford: Elsevier

Research Experience

University of Montana, MT & Denali National Park and Preserve, AK

Jan. 2019 – May 2024

Lead Researcher, Denali Alpine Wildlife Project

40 hrs / wk

Collaborative, large-scale research project where I designed, coordinated, and conducted non-invasive field surveys to monitor small and medium-sized mammals (pikas, marmots, ground squirrels) in the Alaskan backcountry, which involved coordinating with partners and agencies, hiring and training technicians and volunteers, data management and analysis, and publishing research findings.

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Hawk Mountain Sanctuary, PA

Aug. – Dec. 2018

International Traineeship

Lived on site and worked closely with international colleagues on environmental education while assisting with the raptor migration count and analyzing and publishing [research on long-term population trends of Northern Saw-whet owls](#).

USGS Eastern Ecological Science Center, MD

Research Technician – joint position with **Chesapeake Bay Trust, MD**

Aug. 2017 – Aug. 2018

Invited to stay on in a joint position to continue previous duties, plus additional roles publishing research and assisting with winter avian influenza field research (PI: Dr. D. Prosser).

Bird Banding Manager (temporary) – with **Project OwlNet, Petit Manán, ME**

Oct. – Nov. 2017

Awarded special permission to take a temporary role (6 weeks) managing and leading a banding station in partnership with the Maine Dept. of Inland Fisheries and Wildlife and the Petit Manán National Wildlife Refuge. While there, I mist netted and banded 173 Northern Saw-whet owls, 1 long-eared owl, and trained 13 volunteers.

Research Technician

May – Aug. 2017

Assisted with waterbird monitoring and banding in collaboration with researchers from US Fish and Wildlife Service and MD DNR. I also helped co-author multiple papers and [build a solar-powered surveillance system to monitor waterbird nests](#).

University of Maryland, MD

Gemstone Honors researcher, Team CATTAILS

Aug. 2013 – May 2017

Multidisciplinary undergraduate team researching cattail fiber sorption properties for oil spill remediation. This included applying for grants, renting lab spaces, conducting greenhouse and lab experiments, and presenting research at a national conference (ESA in Portland, 2017).

Research Technician

2016 – 2017

Stalk eyed fly (*Diopsidae* sp.) genetics research and husbandry (PI: Dr. G. Wilkinson).

Research Technician – joint position with **The National Zoo, Washington D.C.**

May – Aug. 2016

Wood thrush (songbird) husbandry and video processing.

Teaching experience

Alaska Geographic Workshop, Denali National Park & Preserve, AK

Lead Instructor, “Denali’s Alpine Wildlife”

Planned for July 2026

3-day workshop on alpine wildlife research accredited through the University of Alaska, Anchorage.

Columbia University, NY

Guest Lecturer, Eco, Behavior & Conservation of Mammals

Planned for Spring 2026

University of Montana, MT

Guest Lecturer, Mammalogy, “Mammal Social Behaviors”

Nov. 2023

Head Teaching Assistant, Mammalogy lab

Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Botany lab

Spring 2020 & 2021

Teaching Assistant, Principles of Living Systems lab

Fall 2020

University of Maryland, MD

Teaching Assistant, Beginner Trampoline

Spring 2017

Teaching Assistant, Beginner Tumbling and Balancing

Spring 2016

Gymnastics Instructor, Gymkana Troupe Saturday Program (3 hrs / wk)

Jan. 2014 – May 2017

Gymnastics Instructor (substitute), Gymkana Troupe Summer Camp (as needed)

June – July 2015

Gymnastics Instructor, Gymkana Troupe Summer Camp (40 hrs / wk)

June – Aug. 2014

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Research Grants

2025	Sam Freeman Foundation - <i>Hudson Highlands Wildlife Connectivity Project</i>	\$30,000
	Overhills Foundation - <i>Hudson Highlands Wildlife Connectivity Project</i>	\$20,000
2024	The Wildlife Society Travel Grant, The Wildlife Society	\$500
2018	Chesapeake Bay Trust Mini Grant, Chesapeake Bay Trust - <i>JoVE Publication</i>	\$1,250
2016	Maryland Sea Grant, University of Maryland Center for Environmental Science	\$2,000
2015	Bill James Environmental Grant, Maryland Environmental Trust	\$600

Professional Service

Journal Peer Reviewer: *The Southwestern Naturalist* (2025)

Graduate Professional Student Officer, University of Montana (2021 – 2022)

Manuscript English revision: P. Beltrão et. al. 2021

Additional Information

Languages: English (native), Spanish (A1 level)

Professional Associations: The Wildlife Society

Certifications: CPR/AED certified (exp. 2027), Advanced Open Water Diver (AU, 2015), Boater Education Card (MD, 2015)

Volunteer: National Park Service (2019, 2021, 2022), Humane Society of Western Montana (2019 - 2020)